

How the MGU Gets Made

The production and storytelling rules every Morphin Grid Universe film follows: how the universe connects, how it's shot, how much of each film is serialized, and its genres, rating and runtime.

Area	Mandate
Shared universe	Connected through crossover plot elements, settings, cast and characters
Filming	Primarily on location, with soundstages when necessary
Effects	100% practical; CGI and VFX only when necessary
Performance	Actors do their own stunts and their own motion capture
Serialized vs. standalone	70% serialized / 30% standalone across the saga
Genre	Superhero tokusatsu: action and science fiction
Rating	PG-13
Runtime	150–165 min for standard films; up to 181 min for event films

01 • THE SHARED UNIVERSE

Connective tissue comes straight from the show.

- **Settings:** Angel Grove, Angel Grove High, the Youth Center and Ernie's Juice Bar, then the Command Center, which becomes the Power Chamber, which becomes the Astro Megaship. Each base falls the way it does in canon: Rito and Goldar's bomb takes out the Command Center, and Divatox destroys the Power Chamber.
- **Characters:** Zordon and Alpha 5 hold the saga together. Bulk and Skull run through every era, as they did on the show. Ernie, Lt. Stone and the Rangers who pass their powers to new teens carry continuity from team to team.
- **Plot elements:** Power Coins, the Zeo Crystal, Turbo Keys and the Astro Morphers. Each power source is handed down or replaced on screen exactly as the show handled it, and none of them disappears without an explanation.
- **Villains:** Rita, Zedd, the Machine Empire, Divatox and Astronema stay part of one hierarchy that leads up to Dark Specter and the United Alliance of Evil.

02 • FILMING

Real places first. Stages only when necessary.

- **Southern California is home base.** Angel Grove is a California city in canon, and the original series filmed around Los Angeles. Shooting there keeps the look and light of the show.
- **Alien worlds go to real landscapes.** Australia can play Phaedos, as it did for the 1995 film. New Zealand handles other worlds and serves as the safe production hub during the 2020 shutdown, per the 2020 Release Strategy.
- **Soundstages only for what can't exist on location:** Command Center interiors, Zord cockpits, the Moon palace and the Astro Megaship. Each is a full physical set, not a blue box.

03 • EFFECTS

100% practical. CGI and VFX only when necessary.

- **Tokusatsu is a practical-effects tradition.** Super Sentai, the source of Power Rangers, was built on suit actors, miniatures and pyrotechnics. Going practical keeps us faithful to that.
- **Ranger suits and helmets** are real, wearable and fight-ready. Monsters are performed by actors in full creature suits whenever the design allows it.
- **Zords and Megazords:** detailed miniatures shot at high frame rates in miniature cities, plus full-size practical builds (feet, hands, cockpit sections) for the actors to work against. VFX is used for scale, compositing and full transformation sequences, never to make a Zord smaller or weaker.
- **Pyrotechnics are real.** The Ranger explosion pose gets a real explosion.

04 • STUNTS AND MOTION CAPTURE

Actors do their own stunts and their own capture.

- **Martial arts ability is a casting requirement.** The original show was built on real martial artists, and its fight style comes from karate, kickboxing and acrobatics. Every Ranger actor comes in trained, or trains before cameras roll.
- **Each gag is designed, rigged and rehearsed by the stunt team.** Safety rigging, fight rehearsals and insurance are budgeted on every film. No gag gets dropped for being too hard.
- **Motion capture:** when a character has to be digital, such as a Megazord at full scale or a monster that can't be built as a suit, the actor playing that character performs the capture so the performance stays theirs.

70% serialized, 30% standalone.

The source supports a mostly serialized saga. The show ran multi-part stories (*Green with Evil* is five parts), and *In Space* is serialized from start to finish. Every film still has to work for someone seeing it first.

- **Phase 1, 60/40:** new audiences are still coming in, so each film's main story starts and ends on its own while the saga is set up underneath it.
- **Phase 2, 70/30:** the Alliance takes shape, and the teams, villains and power transfers carry from one film to the next.
- **Phase 3, 80/20:** the saga takes over on the way to Zordon's capture and *Countdown to Destruction*.
- **Saga-wide, about 72% serialized.** Across the 23 films (6 / 6 / 11), that works out to roughly 72/28, so **70/30** is the house rule.
- **Non-negotiable:** every film's central conflict resolves within that film, the way an episode of the show wrapped its monster fight. The serialized material lives in the subplots, villains and Zordon's arc.

06 • CONTINUITY

Continuity gets a department with real authority.

- **The Command Center Story Group** reports to President Judd Lynn. It reviews every script, edit and marketing asset against the canon and can block anything that contradicts it.
- **A canon bible and master timeline:** every film is placed on one in-universe timeline. Ranger rosters, power transfers, Zord line-ups and base locations are tracked scene by scene.
- **A physical archive:** every suit, morpher, coin, crystal and set piece is stored, so anything that comes back matches exactly.
- **No recasting unless absolutely unavoidable.** Cast sign multi-picture contracts at hiring, sized to cover their character's full canon run.

07 • GENRE, RATING AND RUNTIME

Superhero tokusatsu at PG-13, running long.

- **Primary genres:** superhero, action and science fiction, in the tokusatsu tradition.
- **Subgenres:** giant-robot and kaiju (Zord battles), martial arts, teen coming-of-age (the Rangers are “teenagers with attitude”), space opera (Machine Empire, KO-35, Eltar), dark fantasy (Rita, Zedd and their sorcery), and comedy carried by Bulk and Skull.
- **Rating: PG-13.** That's high enough for full-intensity fights, Zord combat and real stakes without holding anything back, and it keeps the films open to families, as the show was. An R rating would leave the source behind, and anything below PG-13 would soften the action.
- **Runtime:** standard films run **150–165 minutes** (2h30–2h45), enough to give the story, the fights and the Megazord battle each their full space. Team-ups and phase finales run **165–181 minutes**, capped at 3h01 (the length of *Avengers: Endgame*), which is the limit audiences have accepted.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Real films, people, companies and places are cited as reference and don't imply any real involvement or endorsement.